

Illustration by SIDDHANT JUMDE

GLASSHOUSE

BABUS ON 10TERHOOKS

Nothing like some healthy competition to get government officials going. Or so Uttar Pradesh chief minister Yogi Adityanath hopes with a new internal ranking system. Based on feedback from the CM's helpline number and portal, officials and departments that solve public grievances on priority will get additional marks. Yogi recently announced the top 10 government departments, district magistrates, municipal corporations, development authorities and police stations. The CM also conducts division-wise reviews of development projects, seeking details of expenses from the additional chief secretary of finance. Any negligence will invite action, they have been warned. Laggards, too, beware. Marks will matter.

Chicken and Egg Row

The recent visit of **Siddaramaiah**, former Congress chief minister of Karnataka, to BJP stronghold Kodagu proved quite eventful. First, someone threw an egg at his car as protests greeted him. The huge turnout at his birthday rally earlier this month had rattled the BJP. It was a disgruntled Congressman who did that, claimed the local BJP after the egg-thrower was caught. If so, why did a BJP leader rush to his rescue, asked Siddaramaiah. Next, the BJP leaders accused him of visiting a temple after having chicken curry for lunch. Why couldn't he visit a temple in the evening, Siddaramaiah countered, if people could go to a temple in the morning after eating meat for dinner.



SANDESH RAVIKUMAR

HEAR THAT RRROAR?



ANI

What was behind Union home minister Amit Shah's 20-minute one-on-one meeting with Tollywood actor Junior NTR at a Hyderabad hotel on August 21? Speculation is, he'll endorse the BJP in the 2023 assembly polls in Telangana. The 39-year-old actor's entry into politics could well put N. Chandrababu Naidu and his TDP in an electoral spot in both Telugu-speaking states.



DRESSING DOWN

West Bengal chief minister **Mamata Banerjee**'s cabinet colleagues have apparently been given an unofficial directive to be spartan in their lifestyle. Didi wants them to travel in their constituency on foot or on a cycle. The movement of the pilot cars following their vehicles within the city has also been restricted. There's also restriction on the use of blue beacons atop VIP vehicles. After the recovery of mounds of cash from former minister Partha Chatterjee's close aide, Mamata seems desperate for an image makeover. While she has a simple lifestyle herself, it's not true of some of her ministers.



On Attack Mode

Shunted to the Rajya Sabha after the NDA-JD(U) government came to power in Bihar in 2020, former deputy chief minister **Sushil Modi** seems back in the reckoning after Nitish dumped the saffron side. From attacking Nitish for his ambitions to "exposing" Deputy CM Tejashwi Yadav, Modi is on the warpath. When the RJD tried to get even and their minister Ramanand Yadav accused him of owning two malls in family members' names, Modi promised to gift the properties to Lalu Yadav's family if they could prove the charge.

–Kaushik Deka with *Prashant Srivastava, Ajay Sukumaran, Amarnath K. Menon, Romita Datta and Amitabh Srivastava*